

CREARTBOX

OPENING NIGHT

Currents

Friday, October 30, 2026 · 7:30 pm

450 W 37th St, New York

Guillermo Laporta · Johannes Brahms · Eric Moe
Clara Schumann · Robert Schumann

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NEW YORK SERIES

at The DiMenna Center for Classical Music

12th season

———— 2026 / 27 ————



TRE PEZZI · FEBRUARY 2026

Emilie-Anne Gendron, violin, and Josefina Urraca,
piano, at The DiMenna Center.

Program

GUILLERMO LAPORTA

4'

Brown Leaves Moving

violin, viola, cello and piano

JOHANNES BRAHMS

8'

Trio in A minor, Op. 114

I. Allegro

viola, cello and piano

ERIC MOE

5'

Laminar Flow in Upsidedown Creek

violin, viola and cello

CLARA SCHUMANN

11'

Three Romances, Op. 22

violin and piano

ROBERT SCHUMANN

28'

Piano Quartet in E-flat major, Op. 47

violin, viola, cello and piano

TOTAL PLAYING TIME

56'

Video art by Guillermo Laporta.

This evening's performance lasts approximately 60 minutes and is played without intermission. Please silence all electronic devices. Flash photography is not permitted at any time.

CreArtBox's programs are made possible by the New York State Council on the Arts with the support of the Office of the Governor and the New York State Legislature, and by the NYC Department of Cultural Affairs.

Two of tonight's titles come from the physics of moving fluids. The other three works come from one circle of musicians: Joseph Joachim is the dedicatee of Clara Schumann's Romances and the violist Brahms tried out in the Op. 114 Trio, and Clara gave the first public performance of Robert's Piano Quartet.

GUILLERMO LAPORTA

2018 · 4'

Brown Leaves Moving

Written in 2018 as part of AWAVE, a suite for flute, piano and electronics, first performed in Queens that year. Tonight it is heard in a version for violin, viola, cello and piano.

Its subject is leaves moved by the wind, and that movement is built into the performance rather than only described by it. The players begin offstage and walk slowly on as they play, so the ensemble assembles itself in front of the audience instead of waiting for it.

Laporta founded CreArtBox in New York in 2013 and has combined a flutist's career with theatre direction and lighting design; the staging of a piece is, for him, part of its writing.

Trio in A minor, Op. 114 · I. Allegro

In December 1890 Brahms told his publisher Fritz Simrock that he meant to stop composing. The String Quintet Op. 111, finished that summer, was to be the last thing he published.

In March 1891, visiting the court at Meiningen, he heard the orchestra's principal clarinetist, Richard Mühlfeld. That summer, at Bad Ischl, he wrote two works for him: this Trio and the Clarinet Quintet Op. 115. The Trio was played privately in Meiningen on 24 November 1891 and publicly at the Singakademie in Berlin on 12 December, with Mühlfeld, the cellist Robert Hausmann, and Brahms at the piano.

Simrock published it in March 1892 with a viola part offered as an alternative to the clarinet, the same provision Brahms had made for the Horn Trio Op. 40. Both scorings were rehearsed before publication, with Joachim on viola. That is the version heard tonight, first movement only.

Laminar Flow in Upsidedown Creek

Laminar flow is the term in fluid dynamics for movement in smooth parallel layers with no mixing between them, the opposite of turbulence.

Eric Moe (b. 1954, Durham, North Carolina) studied at Princeton and Berkeley, is Andrew W. Mellon Professor of Composition and Theory at the University of Pittsburgh, and co-directs the Music on the Edge new-music series there. He wrote this piece during one of his residencies at the Montana Artists Refuge in Basin, Montana. Jeanne Golan recorded a piano version of it on *It Takes One to Tango* (Steinway & Sons, 2021), a programme of works with roots in popular music, where it sits alongside Pablo Ortiz's *Three Pieces*.

The work reaches this programme through CreArtBox's open Call for Scores, which places selected composers on the season roster and gives their music a New York performance with the core ensemble.

CLARA SCHUMANN

1853 · 11'

Three Romances, Op. 22

Written in Düsseldorf in 1853, in the same run of work that produced the Variations Op. 20, the piano Romances Op. 21 and the Rollett songs Op. 23. They are dedicated to Joachim, then twenty-two and employed at the Hanoverian court; he and Clara toured them in Germany and Britain, including a performance for King George V, who by Joachim's account was enthusiastic. Breitkopf & Härtel published them in 1855.

They are among the last original works she completed. Brahms, aged twenty, arrived at the Schumanns' door on 30 September 1853; Robert collapsed the following February and entered the asylum at Endenich in March 1854. From then on Clara composed almost nothing new, giving her working life to performing and to editing Robert's music.

Three pieces, each on a single lyric idea, with the piano writing of a virtuoso writing for herself.

Piano Quartet in E-flat major, Op. 47

1842 was Schumann's chamber-music year: the three string quartets Op. 41, the Piano Quintet Op. 44, this Quartet, and the piano trio later published as *Phantasiestücke* Op. 88. The Quartet was sketched between 24 and 30 October and copied out between 7 and 26 November. It is dedicated to Count Matvei Wielhorsky, a Russian amateur cellist known to the Schumanns, which may have something to do with how much the cello is given to do. After a private reading in St Petersburg during the Schumanns' Russian tour, Clara gave the public premiere at the Leipzig Gewandhaus on 8 December 1844, with Ferdinand David on violin and Niels Gade on viola.

Of the two E-flat works the Quintet has always been the more public. The Quartet is the more inward: a scherzo running on staccato scales with two contrasting trios, and a slow movement, *Andante cantabile*, whose melody is handed first to the cello.



That slow movement ends with the cellist tuning the bottom C string down a whole step to B-flat, to hold a pedal note beneath the final bars that the instrument cannot otherwise reach. It serves the music and inconveniences the player, who has to retune mid-movement and back again for the finale.

Chamber music you can see

CreArtBox creates and produces live art performances, fusing classical and contemporary music with original ideas encouraged by multidisciplinary interaction. Its programs are designed to support professional artists, encourage the creation of new meaningful work, make world-class performances accessible to everyone regardless of background or economic circumstance, inspire and educate future generations, revitalize local communities, and nurture new ways of human expression.

Recognized by *The New Yorker* as one of its "art and music top picks," praised by *Time Out* as "an ensemble devoted to multidisciplinary events," and described by *BroadwayWorld* as "wholly authentic, visually and aurally compelling," CreArtBox is celebrated for its ability to enhance the listening experience of live music through theatrical design while preserving the integrity of each composition.

The organization was **founded in New York City in 2013 by flutist Guillermo Laporta and pianist Josefina Urraca**, who continue to serve as its artistic directors, and is **now in its 12th season**. The project was originally conceived in Europe in 2006 as Cre.Art Project by Laporta and clarinetist and performance creator Tagore González.

With its headquarters in New York City and Asturias, Spain, CreArtBox develops an array of distinctive platforms to pursue its mission: **the New York Series at The DiMenna Center for Classical Music**, international touring, a printed magazine, a classical music streaming platform, a live music podcast with the Queens Public Library, an open call and commissioning program for composers, and Festival ADAR, which develops the arts in rural Spain.

The kind of performance that most defines its identity **can be called a visual concert**. Visual art and theatrical design are used to enhance the audience's listening experience of live classical and contemporary music while respecting the original composition, usually in medium-size venues where lights and projections can surround the audience. CreArtBox also plays more traditional chamber music concerts, which have taken the group to Japan, Spain, Europe, Canada, and the east coast of the United States.

The 2026/27 season runs from October to August: **four productions at The DiMenna Center**, eleven works drawn from the ensemble's open Call for Scores, one world premiere, touring dates in Illinois, Kentucky and the Hudson Valley, a residency at the Kuopio Conservatory in Finland, and the seventh Festival ADAR in Asturias.

CreArtBox has run **an open Call for Scores since its first season**, alongside a composer residency program, fostering the creation of new works and mentoring emerging voices. Over the past decade it has presented works by **Pulitzer Prize winners Caroline Shaw and David Lang** and by Timo Andres, Anna Clyne, Nico Muhly, Sebastian Currier, Todd Reynolds, Philip Lasser, Joshua Penman, Andrea Casarrubios, Hannah Selin, Dai Wei, Brian Wysocki, Annamaria Kowalsky, Celeste Oram, JP Jofre, Marcos Fernández, Michael Grebla, Nathan Schram and Cullynn Murphy, among many others.

Composers reaching the current season through the call include Eric Moe, a Guggenheim fellow honoured by the American Academy of Arts and Letters; Zygmund de Somogyi, a Royal Philharmonic Society composer for 2025 and Festival ADAR's composer in residence; Eli Tausen á Lava, nominated for the 2026 Nordic Council Music Prize; and Paul Novak and Sam Wu, both winners of the ASCAP Foundation's Morton Gould Young Composer Award.

Each core member brings a distinctive artistic trajectory: Laporta has combined a career as a flutist with theater directing and lighting design; Urraca is an acclaimed solo and chamber pianist, a pupil of Dmitri Bashkurov; Gendron is a longtime member of the Momenta Quartet and one of the concertmasters of the Orpheus Chamber Orchestra; Cohen is a special prize winner at the Primrose International Viola Competition; and Yang is a founding member of the Naumburg-winning Merz Trio.

Alongside its concert programs, CreArtBox has produced a series of theatrical and interdisciplinary works, including *Architecture of a Common Man* (2023), the opera-ballet *Two Roads* (2019), *Visuality* (2012/14), the opera *Noctum* (2011), the musical *London: The Show* (2009), and *Cre.Art Project I* (2006).

CreArtBox works with visual artists, designers, dancers and other creative minds to craft multi-layered performances centered around classical music, with a roster of musicians that includes members of the Metropolitan Opera Orchestra, the New York Philharmonic, the BBC Orchestra, and the Chamber Music Society of Lincoln Center.

The ensemble has been awarded the Queens Council on the Arts New Work Grant and the New York Foundation for the Arts Fellowship, and is supported by the New York State Council on the Arts, the NYC Department of Cultural Affairs, the Amphion Foundation, the Alice M. Ditson Fund, the Aaron Copland Fund for Music, Spain Arts and Culture, and the Government of Asturias, alongside a group of individual supporters. In addition to its American-based activities, CreArtBox **co-produces Festival ADAR**, an international arts festival held since 2021 in Asturias, Spain, dedicated to revitalizing rural communities through music, contemporary creation, artist residencies, and site-specific projects.

TONIGHT'S PERFORMERS

Josefina Urraca PIANO · CO-DIRECTOR

Josefina Urraca is a Spanish pianist and co-director of CreArtBox and of Festival ADAR. Her playing has been praised by *Mundo Clásico* for its blend of "introspection and musical abandon" - a balance between precision and emotional risk that defines her work both on stage and behind it. She has performed at the Salle Cortot in Paris, the Collège d'Espagne at the Cité Internationale Universitaire de Paris, the Sony Auditorium in Madrid, and Carnegie Hall in New York, and her work has reached wider audiences through Spanish television and radio.

She trained at the Reina Sofia School of Music in Madrid, where she studied with Dmitri Bashkirov, and also at the Salamanca Conservatory, the École Normale de Musique "Alfred Cortot" in Paris, and the Manhattan School of Music in New York. She has been recognized in competitions including INJUVE, the Ciudad de Carlet International Competition, and the Savvy Musicians in Action International Competition, and her work has received support from the New York State Council on the Arts, the NYC Department of Cultural Affairs, the Queens Council on the Arts, and the Government of Asturias.

In 2013, alongside flutist Guillermo Laporta, she co-founded CreArtBox, and since 2021 the two have co-directed Festival ADAR in rural Asturias, bringing concerts, commissions, artist talks, and site-specific installations to small villages.

Emilie-Anne Gendron VIOLIN

Violinist Emilie-Anne Gendron, lauded by the *New York Times* as a "brilliant soloist" and by *Strad Magazine* for her "marvelous and lyrical playing," enjoys a dynamic career based in New York City. A deeply committed chamber musician, Ms. Gendron is a longtime member of the Momenta Quartet, currently quartet-in-residence at Binghamton University, and whose vision encompasses contemporary music of all backgrounds alongside great music from the past. She is a member and one of the concertmasters of the acclaimed Orpheus Chamber Orchestra and also collaborates with groups such as A Far Cry, Argento Chamber Ensemble, Chamber Music Society of Lincoln Center, Chamber Orchestra of Philadelphia, CreArtBox, INTERWOVEN, Iris Collective, Marlboro Music Festival / Musicians From Marlboro, New Asia Chamber Music Society, Orchestra of St. Luke's, Talea Ensemble, The Knights, and Sejong.

Ms. Gendron holds the distinction of being the first person in Juilliard's history to be accepted simultaneously to its two most selective courses of study, both the Doctor of Musical Arts and the Artist Diploma. She holds a B.A. in Classics and Ancient Studies from Columbia University.

Ms. Gendron plays on a 1673 Jacob Stainer violin on generous loan from the Englewood Chamber Players.

Matthew Cohen VIOLA

Ukrainian-American violist Matthew Cohen is a dynamic and versatile artist whose captivating performances have made him one of the most sought-after violists of his generation. Recently appointed as the violist of the Formosa Quartet and a founding member of Ensemble Elatós, he was a special prize winner at the prestigious Primrose International Viola Competition as well as garnering top prizes at the Citta di Cremona International Viola Competition in Italy, Vivo International Music Competition and the Art of Duo International Competition. Particularly interested in advocating for the viola as a unique voice, he is challenging the misconception that the viola has a limited repertoire by bringing attention to lesser-known gems as well as arrangements of other masterworks.

As a graduate of the Juilliard School's Master of Music program, he was the proud recipient of a Kovner Fellowship; he earned his Bachelor of Music degree from Cleveland Institute of Music and received an Artist Diploma from Colburn Conservatory where he studied with Misha Amory, Heidi Castleman, Paul Coletti, Jeffrey Irvine, and Cynthia Phelps.

Julia Yang CELLO

Praised for "her sense of joyful virtuosity" as concerto soloist (*South Florida Classical Review*), Julia Yang is a courageous and soulful cellist, multi-faceted performer, and founding member of the "riveting" (*Reading Eagle*) and "impeccably elegant" Merz Trio (*All About the Arts*) and freshly minted clarinet-cello-piano ensemble, Trio Phōs.

On stage, Yang has been described as the "stunning find of the evening" (*New York Classical Review*) and has been noted for her "dark, voluminous tone" and "utterly compelling" performances (*South Florida Classical Review*).

Yang's Merz Trio are first prize winners of the prestigious Naumburg Chamber Music Prize as well as of the Concert Artists Guild, Fischhoff and Chesapeake International Chamber Music competitions. The Trio presents innovative multidisciplinary concert experiences that interweave repertoire of the traditional piano trio genre with diverse art forms ranging from the visual arts, literature and dance to theatre and the culinary arts.

Yang has collaborated in chamber music with numerous artists including Jonathan Biss, Mitsuko Uchida, and Kim Kashkashian at festivals such as the Marlboro Music Festival, Lake Champlain Chamber Music Festival, Yellow Barn, The Valley of the Moon Festival, At the World's Edge Festival, Tippet Rise and Poland's Krzyszowa-Music.

Guillermo Laporta

VISUAL ARTIST · EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

Guillermo Laporta is a Spanish flutist, composer, and designer based in New York City. His multidisciplinary practice brings together music, film, and theatrical design, with works including *Architecture of a Common Man* (2023), *Two Roads* (2020), and *Noctum* (2011). Critics have praised his “impressive staging” (*El País*) and “unique take on classical music” (*Times Ledger*).

Laporta is co-founder, Executive Director, and Co-Artistic Director of CreArtBox, the New York chamber music organization he established with pianist Josefina Urraca in 2013, creating performances that integrate music with visual art, projection, and theatrical staging. In 2021, they founded Festival ADAR in rural Asturias, Spain, presenting concerts, commissions, artist residencies, and site-specific installations.

As a flutist, Laporta has performed with ensembles including the BBC Orchestra and at venues such as Carnegie Hall and Lincoln Center. Expanding the flute repertoire is central to his work through original compositions, transcriptions, and chamber music. He has released three studio albums, with recording credits on Warner Music, EMI, and Naxos. From 2009 to 2012, he served as co-principal flutist of the Oviedo Filarmonía.

Laporta studied at the Royal College of Music in London with flutist and conductor Jaime Martín.



MUSICA RICERCATA · DECEMBER 2025

The ensemble at The DiMenna Center.

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- 03 Bring music into schools, libraries and community spaces across New York
- 04 Continue producing interdisciplinary programming



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BRAHMS

Piano Quartet No. 3

III. Andante, at The
DiMenna Center

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SCAN TO WATCH

play.creartbox.nyc

Free on the App Store and Google Play: search for
CreArtBox.

The rest of the season

Three more productions at The DiMenna Center.

Dec 11 2026	Winterlight Selin · Ravel · Caplan · Stravinsky
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Apr 23 2027	Pressure and Release Seven premieres from the Call for Scores
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May 7 2027	Feverdream de Somogyi · á Lavamúrurin · Sibelius
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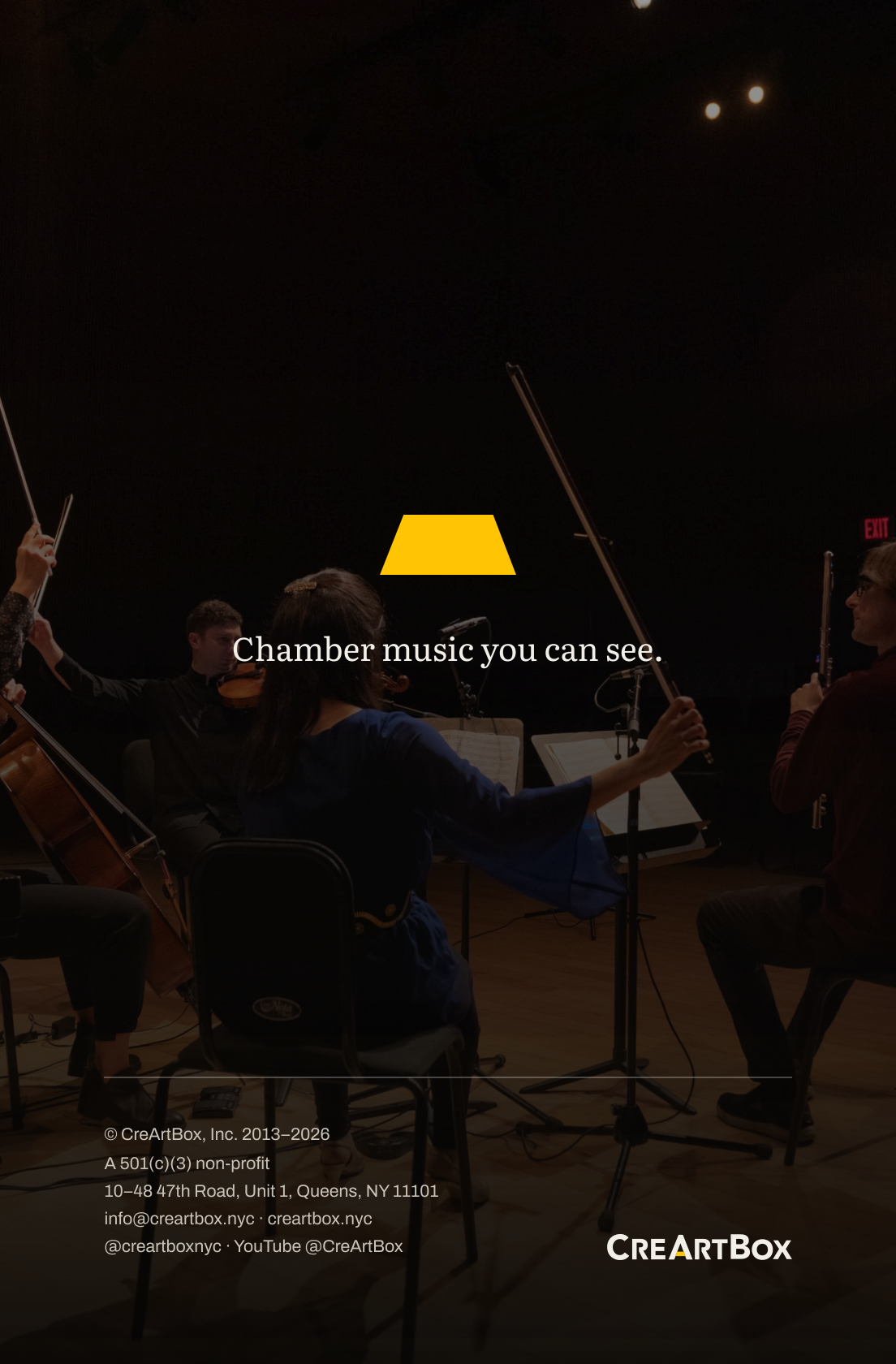
ON TOUR AND BEYOND

Nov 6	Engelbach-Hart Music Festival	Illinois
Feb 28	Chamber Music Society of Louisville	Kentucky
Apr 18	Masked Sounds	Saugerties, NY
Aug 2–15	Festival ADAR · 7th edition	Asturias

FULL CALENDAR

creartbox.nyc/concerts





Chamber music you can see.

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